

Paper 2: Human geography

Externally assessed

2.1 Description

This paper brings together human geography and people-environment processes and interactions. The paper is divided into three sections.

Section A – students choose **two** out of three topics from: economic activity and energy, rural environments and urban environments.

- Topic 4: Economic activity and energy – variations in economic activity over time and spatially, the relationship between population and resources and detailed case studies of energy resource management in a developed **and** a developing **or** emerging country.
- Topic 5: Rural environments – distribution, characteristics and human activities taking place in rural environments, the changes in contrasting rural environments and detailed case studies of rural environments in a developed **and** a developing **or** emerging country.
- Topic 6: Urban environments – trends, characteristics and problems associated with urban environments, the challenges facing contrasting urban environments and detailed case studies of urban environments in a developed **and** a developing **or** emerging country.

Section B – students are required to undertake a geographical investigation, involving fieldwork and research, in **one** human environment. In this paper, students choose **one** out of three fieldwork-related questions from: economic activity and energy, rural environments and urban environments.

Section C – students are required to apply their knowledge and understanding of human and physical geography to investigate broader global issues. Students choose **one** out of three questions from: fragile environments and climate change, globalisation and migration, and development and human welfare.

- Topic 7: Fragile environments and climate change – distribution, characteristics and threats facing the world's fragile environments, the impacts of different processes, including climate change, on fragile environments, and different approaches to managing fragile environments in a more sustainable way.
- Topic 8: Globalisation and migration – the characteristics and growth in globalisation, including the role of global institutions and transnational corporations, and the impacts of increased globalisation, including migration and tourism and different approaches to managing migration and tourism in a more sustainable way.
- Topic 9: Development and human welfare – definitions and ways of measuring development and human welfare, patterns of global development and the consequences of variations in development, and different strategies to address uneven levels of development and human welfare.

2.2 Assessment information

Examination length: 1 hour and 45 minutes.

Examination paper is in three sections.

Section A (50 marks).

Candidates choose two out of three questions on: economic activity and energy, rural environments, and urban environments.

Section B (20 marks).

Candidates choose one out of three fieldwork-related questions on: economic activity and energy, rural environments, and urban environments.

Section C (35 marks).

Candidates choose one out of three questions on: fragile environments and climate change, globalisation and migration, and development and human welfare.

Total for paper: 105 marks.
